

FAL	Key Words	Learning Objective	< 6	6 → 7	7.5 → 8	8.5 → 9	9.5 → 10
1,4,6	Challenge	LO 1 Envision and substantiate a design [or research] challenge.	No clear design [or research] challenge is substantiated.	A design [or research] challenge is identified and substantiated with supporting evidence.	A relevant design [or research] challenge is clearly substantiated with evidence from reliable sources.	An emergent design [or research] challenge is coherently articulated through multiple, integrated sources and demonstrates relevance within the project domain.	A visionary design (or research) challenge is coherently articulated through multiple, integrated sources and advances thinking within the project domain.
2,3,5	Methods	LO 2 Select and apply design [or research] methods appropriate to the challenge.	Method selection is not clearly justified. Methods are improperly applied.	The selection of methods are justified through examples from the same domain as the project and applied sufficiently.	The selection of methods are made from domains related to that of the project and applied effectively.	Methods are purposefully selected and adapted from related domains to address key aspects of the project and are applied systematically.	Methods demonstrate an original yet rigorous application that extends or reconfigures existing approaches, constituting a methodological contribution to the project domain.
3,4,11	Process	LO 3 Improve design [or research] concepts through integrative prototyping and testing.	Concepts are poorly developed or insufficiently justified. Prototyping and testing do not inform project decisions.	Concepts are conventional and partially justified. Prototyping and testing inform project decisions.	Concepts are justified and aligned with the project context. Prototyping and testing support iterative development.	Concepts are credible, and well justified. Systematic prototyping and testing clearly guide further iterations.	Concepts are creative, coherent, and highly developed. Rigorous and reflective prototyping and testing lead to outcomes approaching implementable quality.
2,8,11	Result	LO 4 Deliver outcomes that fulfil the design [or research] challenge and contribute toward positive impact.*	The challenge is not adequately addressed. Consideration of selected impact dimensions* is largely absent.	The core challenge is addressed at a basic level. Selected impact dimensions* are identified but remain superficial.	The challenge is convincingly addressed. Selected impact dimensions* are appropriately developed and contextualised.	The challenge is addressed in depth. Selected impact dimensions* are critically explored within the immediate project scope.	The outcomes create value beyond the project scope and context. Selected impact dimensions* are synthesised into transferable insights, guidelines, or principles for future challenges.
6,7,9	Management	LO 5 Manage associated complexities of the project.	Project management and stakeholder engagement are ineffective. The student relies heavily on supervision. The project encounters delays.	The project is completed with guidance. Stakeholder engagement is present but limited. The project is delivered with minimal delay.	Project management is effective. The student demonstrates independent decision-making and engages relevant stakeholders. The project is delivered in nominal time.	The project is proactively and autonomously managed. Independent and effective decision-making in collaboration with stakeholders is evident. The project is delivered in nominal time.	Project management is highly professional and creates strategic value for stakeholders. The student establishes new or sustained stakeholder relationships. The project is delivered in nominal time.
	Ethics	LO 6 Shape decisions with ethical consideration.	Ethical considerations are absent, inappropriate, or misunderstood.	Ethical considerations are identified and appropriately inform decisions.	Ethical considerations are consistently applied to inform key decisions.	Ethical considerations are thoughtfully integrated and shape responsible project processes and outcomes.	Ethical considerations are self-initiated and set the standard for responsible project outcomes and future practices.
7,10	Communication	LO 7 Clearly communicate during the project across modalities.**	Communication is unclear, inconsistent, or ineffective, limiting understanding of the project.	Communication enables understanding of project processes and outcomes.	Communication is consistent and clear across modalities to support engagement with project processes and outcomes.	Communication is well-integrated across modalities, enhancing understanding and engagement with project processes and outcomes.	Communication across modalities is intentionally composed and interconnected, resulting in a compelling and cohesive understanding of project processes and outcomes.
6,7	Reflection	LO 8 Reflect on the project from the perspective of academic and professional standards.	Reflection is absent, minimal, or disconnected from academic and professional standards.	Reflection considers the project in connection to relevant academic and professional standards.	Reflection evaluates the project by identifying strengths and limitations in relation to relevant academic and professional standards.	Reflection critically considers the project outcome, using academic and professional standards to examine the quality and significance of the work.	Reflection demonstrates exceptional insight and extends understanding of practice and academic standards.

* **Impact Dimensions:** The student and supervisors select three impact dimensions for assessment. These may include: viability, desirability, feasibility, sustainability, aesthetics, and responsibility. The selected dimensions should align with the project context, be discussed during the kick-off meeting, and be formally agreed upon with the student at the mid-term evaluation. ** **Modalities:** written, verbal, visual.

Impact Criteria.

Select 3 at the Mid-term Evaluation

Sustainability is a critical impact factor in design, shaping how projects respond to environmental limits, social responsibility, and long-term value. Designers influence material use, production systems, behaviours, and futures; sustainability ensures these decisions minimise harm while supporting resilience and equity.

Responsibility is a vital impact factor in design, guiding ethical decision-making and accountability for social, cultural, and environmental consequences. It considers power, inclusion, risk, and long-term effects, ensuring design actions do not cause harm. By foregrounding responsibility, design practice acknowledges its influence and commits to acting with care, integrity, and respect for people, communities, and contexts.

Aesthetics is a significant impact factor in design, shaping how outcomes are perceived, interpreted, and valued. It influences form, materiality, expression, and coherence, contributing to meaning and emotional resonance. Through aesthetic judgement, design communicates intent and quality, supporting clarity, engagement, and cultural relevance within its intended context.

Desirability is a critical impact factor in design, reflecting the extent to which outcomes meet the needs, values, and aspirations of users and stakeholders. It considers experience, meaning, and cultural relevance, ensuring designs are engaging and appropriate to their context. By addressing desirability, design practice centres human experience, supporting solutions that are not only functional but also valued and embraced.

Feasibility is an essential impact factor in design, assessing whether proposed ideas can be realised within existing technical, material, temporal, and resource constraints. It grounds creative ambition in practical conditions, testing what is possible in a given context. By addressing feasibility, design practice balances imagination with practicality, ensuring concepts can move from proposal to implementation.

Viability is a key impact factor in design, ensuring that ideas can be realistically implemented, sustained, and scaled within real-world constraints. It addresses feasibility across economic, technical, organisational, and social conditions, translating conceptual propositions into actionable outcomes. By foregrounding viability, design practice connects innovation with practical execution, strengthening the capacity of design to produce meaningful, durable impact within its intended context.